

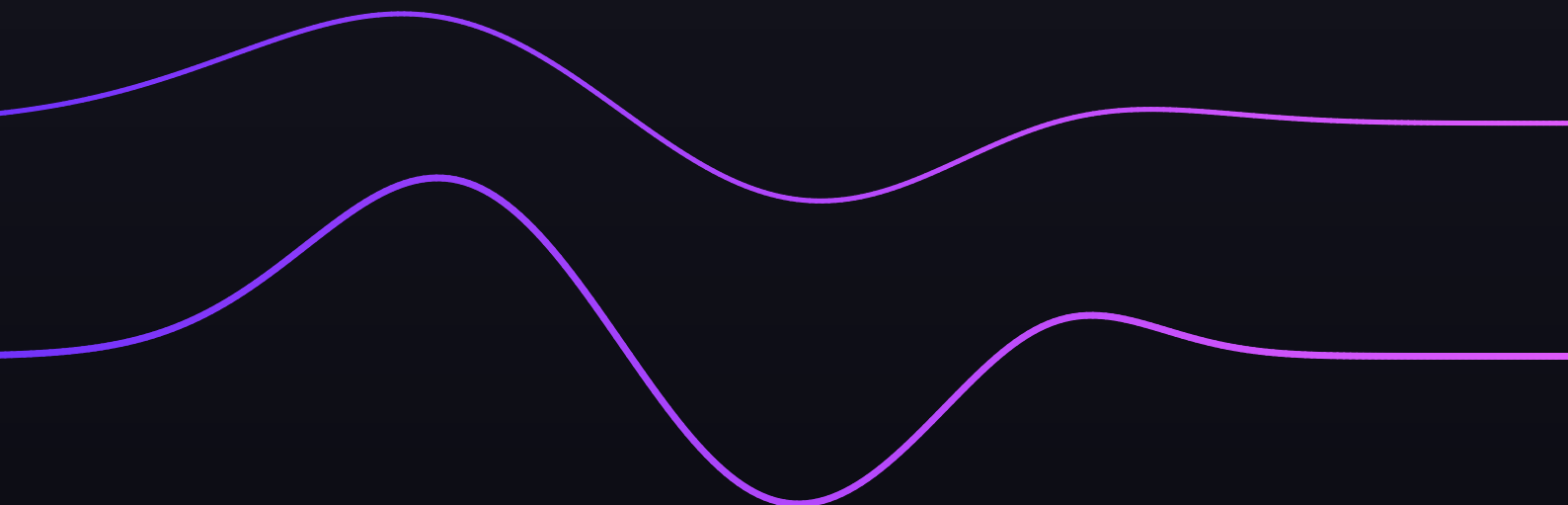


OmniAPO

System-wide audio processing with VST3 plugin hosting

Version 1.0.1
August 2026

Built from source. Offered as donationware — free to use, with no paid tier and no network access.



What OmniAPO is

A private, from-source Windows build of Equalizer APO, the free system-wide audio equalizer. It runs as an Audio Processing Object inside the Windows audio pipeline, so it processes the sound of every application at once - not one player at a time. There is no service to start and nothing to keep open.

It descends from the double-precision, AVX2 fork of Equalizer APO 1.4.2 and adds its own changes on top: VST3 plugin hosting, five bug fixes, a registration self-repair, an offline configuration reference and a configuration checker.

The name is the product, the paths are the plumbing

OmniAPO installs to `C:\Program Files\EqualizerAPO` and keeps the registry key `HKLM\Software\EqualizerAPO`. Peace, HeSuVi and other front ends locate the engine through exactly those and nothing else, so renaming them would leave every one of those tools unable to find it. Only what you see on screen is OmniAPO. The installer does not offer the location as a choice, deliberately.

Who it is for

Anyone already running Equalizer APO on 64-bit Windows - directly or through a front end such as Peace or OmniEQ - who wants the double-precision fork's fixes, or who wants to run VST2/VST3 plugins in the same real-time path as their EQ.

It is not a general-audience release with support behind it. It is built for one machine, and the honest limitations below are part of the deal.

How it differs from stock Equalizer APO

- **VST3 plugin hosting** alongside the existing VST2 support, in the same filter chain, with class selection by GUID, state persistence and latency compensation.
- **Renaming a device no longer breaks its configuration.** A `Device:` line carrying a matching endpoint GUID now matches regardless of the name words.
- **Disabling effects no longer silences capture devices** whose input and output channel counts differ.
- **Device names with illegal filename characters** no longer break installation.
- **Self-repair.** A wiped APO registration - the usual aftermath of a Windows feature update - is detected and offered for one-click repair instead of silently disabling all processing.
- **A configuration checker.** `Benchmark.exe` - -check reports what the engine rejected in your configuration, which otherwise only reaches a log file.
- **An offline configuration reference** replacing the two links to the upstream wiki, written from this build's own source.

Getting started

Install

Run the installer. It preserves an existing `config` folder untouched, so an upgrade keeps your setup. Processing is active as soon as it finishes - no restart.

Check that a configuration is sound

`Benchmark.exe --check` loads the installed configuration and prints every problem the engine found. Add `--config <folder>` to check a configuration before copying it into place. It exits with code 1 if anything was reported.

Read the details

The Start Menu group holds the illustrated guide and an offline configuration reference covering every command the engine understands, written against this build's source rather than the upstream wiki.

Honest limitations

- **Built by one person, on one machine.** Offered as donationware, as-is, with no support commitment behind it.
- **x64 only.** No ARM64 build; every native dependency would need rebuilding.
- **AVX2 required.** The DSP is compiled for it. Pre-2013 CPUs will not run this build.
- **A misspelled command name is dropped silently.** The engine does not report unknown commands, and the checker therefore cannot either.
- **Plugin latency changes mid-stream** are picked up at the next configuration reload, not immediately.
- **Impulse responses are limited to common containers.** Convolution files are decoded by `libsndfile` inside `audiodg.exe`, and `libsndfile` 1.2.2 - still upstream's latest - has published parser defects including a buffer overflow on malformed IRCAM data. The format is read from the file's header, not its extension, so renaming would not avoid the affected parser. This build accepts only WAV, Wave64, AIFF, FLAC, Ogg and CAF and refuses the rest before `libsndfile` sees them. That narrows the surface; it does not fix `libsndfile`, so a malformed WAV still reaches the WAV parser.

Licence and credits

Equalizer APO was created by **Jonas Thedering** and is free software; OmniAPO would not exist without it. The double-precision fork it builds on is TheFireKahuna's.

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